3Card Royale

A4 QUICK REFERENCE

Standard Rules 1.0

One deck. Two players. Three cards. Make them bloom.

SETUP **52 cards · no jokers · 8 cards each · start at level 2**

Hands stay private; wounds start empty. Choose the first attacker at random.

Shared wild: **♥2** first, then the heart of the last winner's new level. Fixed for the game.

01 Hands & scores

		pts
Five of a kind	A♠ A♥ A♣ A♦ 2♥	7
Four of a kind	7♠ 7♥ 7♣ 7♦	6
Three of a kind	Q♠ Q♥ Q♣	5
Straight flush	6♣ 7♣ 8♣	4
Flush	3♦ 8♦ K♦	3
Straight	4♠ 5♥ 6♣	2
Pair	9♠ 9♥ K♣	1
High card	3♠ 8♥ K♣	0

Compare score, then rank. A high, 2 low. Pairs: pair then kicker. Flush / high card: compare high to low. Suits never break ties.

A23 is lowest, QKA highest. KA2 is not a straight.

Five of a kind: all 4 natural cards + the wild, at a different rank from the wild. Examples use ♥2.

02 Attack & defend

Use your hand, your face-up wounds, or both.
Play 3 cards, or 4 / 5 only for four / five of a kind. Attacker reveals first; defender responds. No need to match the type or card count.

Attack wins
Rival takes the score gap in wounds

Defense wins
Defender gets the gap in swap chances

Same type, rank-only win: 1. Exact tie: 0.

Discard plays → refill used wounds → resolve.
Refill wound slots face up, attacker first. Then apply wounds or swaps. Using wounds never heals.

5+ wounds loses the game.
Apply all wounds; do not stop counting at 5.

03 Swap - or skip

Give 1 hand or wound card. Swap with:

1. Rival's hand: random and unseen
2. Rival's wounds: a chosen face-up card
3. Your other zone: hand ↔ wound
4. Deck: discard, draw into the same slot

Counts stay fixed; no healing.
Use or skip each chance independently.

04 Rounds & refills

Both attack once → refill hands to **8**, first attacker first. Next round, reverse who starts: **A → B → B → A**. Keep wounds. Empty deck? Shuffle the discards.

05 Reach Ace. Win and bloom.

Game winner climbs by the final wound gap, capped at A. Rival has 7, you have 2: climb 5.

Level owner = last winner (first game: initial attacker). Fixed for the whole game.

Win your own A game as level owner to win the match.
Reaching A is not enough. If both are at A, only the owner can clear it this game.

Only losing your own A game counts as a failure. Stay at A twice; third loss: reset to 2, clear failures. Rival keeps their level.

New game: shuffle all 52, clear wounds, deal 8 each. Keep levels and unreset Ace failures. Last winner attacks first.

One page. Ready for the table.

lucienzhu.github.io/gk-royale-playtest

Full rules / play